



## US laws to rein-in Apple and Google

US lawmakers have introduced a bill to rein in the Apple App Store and Google Play Store. <https://digit.in/sep21-57>



## Decentralized Internet

Decentralized network Helium announces 118,000 hotspots, challenging centralized Internet. <https://digit.in/sep21-58>

# Which is the best smartwatch?

It's simple, there isn't one

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his is a question that the Digit Team has been asked a lot, especially over the past year. As is the

case when anyone comes to us for buying advice, we ask a series of counter questions first to understand the requirements of the user better. Traditionally, watches are something like jewellery for men, similar to fountain pens, with a function of “showing off”, but having innovative engineering within them as well. The face, dials and straps are all cosmetic additions to the watch, with the mechanism being at the heart of what a watch really is, and connoisseurs are blind to all the other superficial stuff. Smartwatches do not fall in the same category at all. There is absolutely no reason to wear a dress watch to bed, even if you are the kind of snob who just feels good about wearing one, even in isolation. There are very compelling reasons for wearing smartwatches to bed, as it allows users to track sleep quality and energy levels.

The first question buyers have to ask is why do they want to buy a smartwatch? If the answer is to replace the watch already on their wrists, and only that, then the simple answer is that smartwatches are still not the better option, not by a long shot. It is still preferable opting

for that Seiko Automatic, the sharp MVMT or planning for something better. The smartwatch is going to be in a garbage dump somewhere long before your analog timepiece stops ticking. If the answer is to track your fitness or wellness, then there are dedicated devices for tracking heart rate, steps, SpO2 levels and body



The Fitbit Sense

temperature levels, which became important after the pandemic. These are the smart bands or fitness trackers that are still different from the smartwatches. The functionality that smartwatches offer over and above the fitness trackers, is if you want to have a secondary screen

for interfacing with your phone. Do you need alerts on your wrist from particular apps? Do you want to go for a run and keep your phone at home? If the answer is yes, then the smartwatch is for you, but remember that the batteries remain a crippling problem. You really cannot use all the smart features of a smartwatch and not compromise on the fitness and wellness benefits of it, as the device has to be charged at some point. Also, this is a kind of a chicken and egg scenario, as consumers have no way of knowing which is the smartwatch that works best for them without trying out all the apps and services available, most of which are stuffed with dark patterns, excessive IAP and pushy subscription services. Almost all smartwatches have one app for tracking the data, and another app for syncing the data with HealthKit or Fit. These apps may have a subscription service or IAP for just syncing the data. Then there is the problem of compatibility. For example, if you are an Android user, there is no point in buying an Apple Watch.

It helps making a buying decision if there are some functions that you particularly need. Apple, Samsung and Fitbit are among the few with FDA approved ECGs. The Goqii and Honor smartwatches have temperature sensors. The Fitbit Sense has